

In the original 1993 *Master of Orion*, the planetary controls are the heart of your empire's economy. These controls are located on the right side of the **Colony Screen** and consist of five horizontal sliders.

Each slider represents a percentage of that planet's total production (measured in **BC**, or Billions of Credits).

The Five Control Sliders

Slider Name	Display Text (Next to Slider)	Primary Function & Effects
Ship	(Ship Name) & Turns	Allocates production toward building the ship design currently selected in the shipyard. The text displays the name of the ship and how many turns remain until completion.
Def	Bases & Shield	Builds Missile Bases for planetary defense. If you have researched planetary shields, it also funds their construction. Once bases/shields are maxed, this slider can be used to upgrade them to newer tech.
Ind	Factories	Builds new Factories . Each factory increases the planet's total production. In MOO1, factories are limited by your population (e.g., 2 factories per 1 million colonists, though this increases with tech).

Eco	Clean / Terraform	Used for two critical tasks: 1. Clean (removes industrial pollution) and 2. Terraform (increases the planet's maximum population capacity or "Life Support").
Res	(Field Name)	Directs production into Research . This contributes to your empire-wide tech levels (Computers, Construction, Force Fields, Planetology, Propulsion, and Weapons).

Detailed Slider Mechanics

- **The "Eco" Slider Logic:** This is often the most important slider to manage.
 - **Pollution:** Factories generate waste. If you don't fund "Clean," your planet's environment will eventually degrade.
 - **Growth:** Once pollution is at 0, excess Eco spending goes toward **Terraforming** (increasing max population) or **Population Growth** (speeding up how fast your colonists reproduce).
- **The "Ind" Slider Cap:** You cannot build infinite factories. Once you reach the maximum number of factories your current population can support, the slider text will indicate you are "Maxed." Any further investment here is redirected into the **Planetary Reserve** (your empire's bank).
- **The "Def" Slider Importance:** Unlike ships, Missile Bases have no maintenance cost once built. They use the latest missile and computer tech you have researched. If you research a new missile, you must put a small amount into the "Def" slider to "refit" your old bases to the new technology.
- **Production Overflow:** If a project (like a Ship or Missile Base) is finished and there is leftover production from that turn, the game automatically applies it to the next item in that category or returns it to the general pool.

The Display Numbers

Next to the sliders, you will see two sets of numbers:

1. **Production (BC):** The first number is the current amount of BC being generated by the

planet's workers and factories.

2. **Max Production:** Often shown in parentheses, this represents what the planet *could* produce if it were at maximum population and factory capacity.

Would you like me to explain how to optimize these sliders for the early game, such as the "Industrial Expansion" strategy?

[The Master of Orion 1 colony management](#)

This video provides a visual walkthrough of the colony screen and how the sliders interact with your empire's resources.